

Teacher Pack — Handouts 1–4

Covers the four handouts in census-esl-handouts-1-4.pdf: the four to run **before Census night, Tuesday 11 August 2026**.

Print census-esl-handouts-1-4.pdf double-sided: sixteen A4 pages, four per handout — two of exercises, then two answer pages.

The answer pages are in the learner file, by design. Every answer carries a short reason and a fuller one, so learners can mark their own work and understand why. To withhold them, print only pages 1–2, 5–6, 9–10 and 13–14.

Before you teach any of it

Nothing personal is collected. Every task runs on the fictional Haddad household. Where a learner writes their own name or street in the boxes (Handouts 2 and 3), the page says *keep this and take it home* — it is never handed in, displayed or marked.

You teach the form, not the census. When a learner asks what to put for their own situation — a visa question, a shared-care arrangement, a household that doesn't fit the boxes — the answer is **1800 181 227**, or **TIS National 131 450** for an interpreter. Not your best guess. Handout 1's speaking task and every take-home strip rehearse exactly this, so learners can self-serve after the course ends.

Compulsory and confidential, in that order. Several learners will have arrived from states where a government headcount was a threat. Handout 1 teaches both words in the same vocabulary set deliberately. Don't teach one without the other.

Levels are not printed on the learner sheets. Everyone in the room gets the same page and the same topic. Differentiation is in the **↓ More support** and **↑ More challenge** boxes, which are phrased as choices rather than as levels. The level mapping below is for your planning only.

HANDOUT	LEVEL	RUNS IN
1 · Census night is Tuesday 11 August	pre-A1 / A1	50 min
2 · How to write your answers	pre-A1 / A1	50 min
3 · Where do you live?	A1	50 min
4 · Who is in your house?	A1 / A2	50 min

The Haddad household

Reused across the whole series, so learners build familiarity rather than meeting new names each week.

Address: Unit 4, 12 Graham Avenue, Fairfield NSW 2165

PERSON	AGE	RELATIONSHIP	ON CENSUS NIGHT
Amal Haddad	41	Person 1, householder	Present
Yusuf Haddad	44	Amal's husband	Present
Layla Haddad	12	Daughter	Present
Nadia Haddad	6	Daughter	Away — slept at her cousin's, on their form
Rana Haddad	68	Amal's mother	Present
Tomas Silva	29	Unrelated boarder	Present — night shift, home Wednesday, not on another form
Karim Haddad	25	Yusuf's cousin	Away — on holiday in Lebanon
Sara Okafor	30	Visitor, friend from Melbourne	Present — one night only

Seven people usually live there; six were present on Census night; two were away. That's deliberate: the mismatch between *who lives here* and *who slept here* is the single hardest idea on the form, and Handout 4 is built on it. It also lands the household on exactly six present, which is the form's per-person column limit — the hook for Handout 4's extension task.

Handout 1 — Census night is Tuesday 11 August

B. Words — 1 b · 2 f · 3 e · 4 c · 5 h · 6 a · 7 d · 8 g

Give learners two minutes with a phone or a bilingual dictionary for the *My language* column before you take feedback. Learners who share an L1 should compare — the disagreements are where the useful teaching is.

C. Understand — 1 T · 2 F · 3 T · 4 T · 5 F · 6 T · 7 T

Item 2 and item 5 are the two that matter. For 2: the form covers everyone in Australia that night, including non-citizens and international visitors; only foreign diplomats are excluded. For 5: the ABS is legally required not to release information in a way likely to identify an individual. Both facts are on page 2 of the form — send learners there rather than asserting it yourself.

D. Practise — Tuesday, 11 August 2026. On the calendar, 11 is in the T column, second row. Numbers: 1800 181 227 · 131 450 · 1800 130 250. Say each in the natural Australian grouping — *eighteen hundred, one-eight-one, two-two-seven* — then again digit by digit.

E. Do it — ✓ 1, 2, 3, 4 · ✗ 5, 6

Number 4 is the one to discuss. The form's rule: include anyone who lives at the address who returned the next day without being included on another form, and it names shift workers explicitly. Number 5 fails because he never spent the night. Number 6 fails because she is on another form — not because she is a child.

Handout 2 — How to write your answers

B. Words — 1 c · 2 f · 3 e · 4 a · 5 b · 6 h · 7 g · 8 d

Specify and *Go to* are the two with the longest reach. *Other (specify)* appears dozens of times across the form; *Go to 19* is a skip instruction, and following a skip is a reading skill many learners have never been taught.

C. Understand — Row 1 ✓. Rows 2–5 ✗: small letters; two letters in one box; no space between words; pencil (the form says blue or black pen only).

D. Practise — Part 2: draw a line through the second T and write H. Part 3: blue or black pen.

Give the whole class 30 seconds of silent box-writing before feedback on part 1. One letter per 7mm square is a **motor skill**, not a rule — learners who have written in a different script, or who write rarely, need the rehearsal more than the explanation.

E. Do it — A M A L / H A D D A D / T O M A S / S I L V A, one letter per box, capitals.

Mark against the three printed criteria only. Do not correct handwriting style, letter shapes, or anything the form doesn't care about.

Handout 3 — Where do you live?

B. Words — 1 b · 2 d · 3 a · 4 f · 5 c · 6 e · 7 g · 8 h

Dwelling is worth dwelling on: it is the form's word for a home, it appears in a dozen questions, and almost no learner will have met it.

C. Understand — Unit/flat/apartment number · street number · street name · suburb/locality · state/territory · postcode

D. Practise 1. NSW New South Wales · VIC Victoria · QLD Queensland · SA South Australia · WA Western Australia · TAS Tasmania · NT Northern Territory · ACT Australian Capital Territory 2. 1 88 · 2 QUEENS PARADE · 3 CLIFTON HILL · 4 VIC · 5 3068 3. Three mistakes: the street number and street name are **swapped**; *graham avenue* is in **small letters**; the state is written out in full instead of the abbreviation **NSW**. (The postcode and suburb are correct — say so, or learners will hunt for a fourth.) 4. Prepare address cards in advance. Invented addresses only — never learners' own. Six or eight cards is plenty; learners swap and repeat.

E. Do it — 4 · 12 · GRAM AVENUE · PARFIELD · NSW · 2169

Handout 4 — Who is in your house?

B. Words — 1 a · 2 c · 3 b · 4 e · 5 d · 6 g · 7 f · 8 h

C. Understand — a 3 · b 5 · c 2 · d 4

D. Practise — 1 P · 2 P · 3 P · 4 P · 5 A · 6 P · 7 P · 8 A · 9 N

The pair to argue about is 6 and 9. Tomas was physically absent on Tuesday night but counts as present — he lives there, worked a night shift, came home Wednesday, and is on no other form. Rana's brother was physically present on Tuesday evening but doesn't count — he went home and slept somewhere else. **Sleeping, not visiting, is what the form measures.** If only one idea survives this lesson, make it that one.

Number 5 is worth a light touch: Nadia is away because she is on another form, and children in shared-care or overnight-stay arrangements are common in the room. Keep it about the form, not about the family.

E. Do it - Q2 — mark all six categories. Me (Amal); Spouse/partner (Yusuf); Babies, children and teenagers (Layla); Other adult family members (Rana); Unrelated housemates, flatmates or boarders (Tomas); Visitors or friends (Sara). - **Q3** — **6** - **Q5** — **2** (Nadia and Karim)

Extension: a household with eight people completes the Census online, or requests an extra paper form on 1800 130 250 using the Census number from the front of the form. Page 3.

Running it in one week

Census night is Tuesday 11 August 2026. If you have four sessions, run them in order. If you have two, this pairing works:

Session 1 (before Census night) — Handout 1, then Handout 2. What it is and when; how to physically fill boxes. A learner who has only this can attempt the form.

Session 2 (before Census night) — Handout 3, then Handout 4. Address, and who to count. These are the two questions people actually get wrong.

If a session lands *after* the 11th, keep the same content and change the framing verb: *did you include...* instead of *will you include...* The language is identical and the vocabulary is no less useful — the form's ideas (usual address, household, dwelling, present and away) recur on every government form a learner will meet.

If you have a third session, jump to Handout 12 rather than 5 — the interpreter and help-line content is most useful during the census period itself.

Materials to prepare

- **Handout file printed double-sided**, one per learner per session.
- **Address cards** for Handout 3 part 4 — six to eight invented Australian addresses on cut-up card, one per pair. Vary unit numbers, states and postcodes.
- **Optional:** a real blank Census form or the ABS sample, one per table, for the "find the rule on page 3 / page 6" extension tasks. Learners navigating a full 26-page authentic document is a genuine skill and worth the table space.
- **A blue or black pen for every learner.** Not a detail — Handout 2 fails without one.

What isn't here yet

Handouts 5–12 and their keys. See `../SERIES_PLAN.md` §8 for the build order: Handouts 5, 6 and 12 are Tier 2, and 7–11 are Tier 3 with the longest shelf life.

